

January 5, 2026

CITY OF CONWAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING
CONWAY CITY HALL
229 MAIN STREET, CONWAY
MONDAY, JANUARY 5, 2026

PRESENT: Mayor Barbara Jo Blain, Mayor Pro Tem Beth Helms, Amanda Butler, William Goldfinch, Julie Hardwick, Justin Jordan and Larry White.

STAFF: Adam Emrick, City Administrator; Mary Catherine Hyman, Deputy City Administrator; John Rogers, Deputy City Administrator; June Wood, Public Information Officer; Jeff Leveille, Technology Services Director; Jason Perzan, Fire Chief; Reggie Jenerette, Solid Waste Director; Robert Cooper, Construction Services Director; Lynn Smith, Human Resource Director; Ted Dudley, Public Utilities Director; Jessica Hucks, Planning and Development Director; Brandon Harrelson, Public Works Director; Dale Long, Police Chief; Timmy Williams, Hospitality and Beautification Director; Kayla Fleming, Municipal Judge; Ashley Smith, Parks and Recreation Director; Kelli Thomas, Deputy PIO; Bobby Wallace, Fleet Maintenance Director; Allison Williams, Finance Director; David Crotts, Procurement and Inventory Division Chief; and Alicia Shelley, City Clerk.

OTHERS: There were approximately 65 others in attendance.

CALL TO ORDER: Mayor Blain called the meeting to order.

INVOCATION/PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE: Jordan gave the invocation and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

The requirements for posting notice of this meeting under South Carolina's Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) were met.

ADMINISTRATION OF OATHS OF OFFICE: Oaths of Office were administered during the swearing in ceremonies for the Council members that were re-elected in the November 2025 Municipal Election. Those included Council Member Amanda Butler, Council Member William Goldfinch, and Council Member Beth Helms.

CONSENT AGENDA:

- A. Approval of a Resolution recognizing Bojangles**
- B. Approval of a Resolution honoring Donzelle's Restaurant**
- C. Approval of a Resolution honoring Singleton's Grocery**
- D. Approval of December 1, 2025 Council Meeting Minutes**

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APPROVAL OF CONSENT AGENDA: Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to approve the January 5, 2026 consent agenda. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

ELECTION OF MAYOR PRO TEM FOR 2026: Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Butler to elect Helms as Mayor Pro Tem for 2026 by acclamation. There was no objection, and the motion carried unanimously.

SPECIAL PRESENTATION:

- A. Presentation of a Resolution recognizing Bojangles** – Blain presented the Bojangles Franchise and Bo Flavor with a Resolution for their investment, holiday spirit, community partnership and exemplary achievements.
- B. Presentation of a Resolution honoring Donzelle’s Restaurant** – Blain presented Donzelle’s Restaurant with a Resolution honoring them for their sixty plus years of business in Conway.
- C. Presentation of a Resolution honoring Singleton’s Grocery** – Blain presented Singleton’s Grocery with a Resolution honoring them for serving the Conway area for generations.
- D. Presentation of Longevity Awards – December 2025 – 15 Years – Julius “Mike” Alford, II, Solid Waste** – Emrick and Butler presented Mike Alford with his longevity award.
- E. Presentation by the Conway Rotary Club** – David Welborn thanked Council and staff for allowing the Reindeer Run for 18 years.
- F. Discussion of a request to rezone approximately 50.64+/- acres of property located on E. Country Club Drive (PIN 339-00-00-0026), from the City of Conway Low/ Medium Residential (R-1) district to the City of Conway Conservation Preservation (CP) district.** Hucks stated that this property was transferred to the city in March of 2025 with the development of the adjacent property. The current zoning is R-1, and the city is requesting to rezone the property to CP, as a significant amount of the property contains a flood zone. This item is for discussion only and Planning Commission will review the requested zoning and hold a public hearing on the proposed zoning at their January 8 meeting.

At Blain’s request, Hucks briefly explained the CP district.

FIRST READING:

- A. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (F) to rezone approximately 0.15+/- acres of property located at 182 Quail Run (PIN 383-09-04-0040), from Horry County Residential, no mobile homes allowed (SF10) district to the City of Conway Low/Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district.** Hucks stated that this property is within the Quail Village development near the university. Annexation is being requested

due to the requirements to connect to city services due to a change in ownership. Restrictive Covenants have been on file since June 2010. Eight other lots within this subdivision have been annexed over the last several years, with the adjacent lot being annexed in 2023. The requested zoning upon annexation is R-1, which is consistent with the zoning of the other lots that have been annexed. Hucks said that council approved first reading of the annexation at the November 3 council meeting, and Planning Commission recommended approval of the requested zoning of R-1 upon annexation at their December 11 meeting. If first reading of the ordinance to zone the property is approved, final reading of both ordinances, to annex and to rezone the property, will be forwarded for consideration at the January 20 council meeting. Hucks said that staff recommends approval.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Butler to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (F) rezoning the property at 182 Quail Run to City of Conway R-1.

Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

- B. First reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (G) to rezone approximately 0.37+/- acres of property located at 801 Donald Street (PIN 369-12-04-0002), from Horry County Residential, no mobile homes allowed (SF10) district to the City of Conway Low/Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district.** Hucks stated that this property is within the Sam Johnson subdivision near Cates Bay Highway, and this request came about due to the city requirement for annexation when a property changes ownership that will connect to city utilities or when there is a change in the name on the utility account. The restrictive covenant has been on file for this property since 1987. Eleven other properties within this subdivision have been annexed over the years and with the adjacent parcel annexed in 2023. The requested zoning upon annexation is R-1, which is consistent with the zoning of the surrounding properties as well as the city's future land use map. Hucks said that City Council approved first reading of the ordinance to annex the subject property at their November 17 meeting, and PC recommended approval of the proposed zoning upon annexation at their December 11 meeting. If first reading of the ordinance to zone the property R-1 is approved, final reading of both ordinances will be forwarded for consideration at the January 20 council meeting. Hucks said that staff recommends approval.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (G) rezoning the property at 801 Donald Street to City of Conway R-1.

Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

- C. First reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (H) to rezone approximately 0.4+/- acres of property located at 5007 Presbyterian Drive (PIN 383-08-02-0010), from Horry County Residential, no mobile homes allowed (SF10) district to the City of Conway Low/Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district.** Hucks stated that this property is within the College Park subdivision near Highway 501 and this request is a result of the city requirements to annex for a connection to city utilities, with restrictive covenants on file since 1998. Sixteen or so other properties have been annexed over the last several years, with the adjacent parcel annexed in 2007. The requested zoning upon annexation

is R-1, which is consistent with the other residential properties within the College Park development as well as the city's future land use map. Hucks said that City Council approved first reading of the ordinance to annex this property at their November 17 meeting and Planning Commission recommended approval of the requested R-1 zoning at their December 11 meeting. If first reading of this ordinance is approved, final reading of both ordinances will be forwarded for consideration at the January 20 council meeting. Hucks said that staff recommends approval.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Jordan to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (H) rezoning the property at 5007 Presbyterian Drive to City of Conway R-1. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- D. First reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (I) to rezone approximately 0.44+/- acres of property located on Hwy 701 N / Main Street (PIN 325-13-01-0013), from City of Conway Low/Medium Density Residential (R-1) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.** Hucks stated that this property is currently zoned R-1 and the applicant is seeking to rezone the property to HC district, which is consistent with the zoning of other properties with frontage along Highway 701 North as well as the city's future land use map. Hucks said that Planning Commission held the public hearing on the request and recommended approval of the requested zoning of HC at their December 11 meeting. Hucks said that staff recommends approval.

Motion: Butler made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-01-20 (I) rezoning the property at Highway 701 N / Main Street to HC. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

White requested that staff add business names to the aerial map.

- E. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (A) to annex approximately 1+/- acres of property located at 3000 Hwy 378 (PIN 337-16-04-0011).** Hucks stated that this property is the location of what used to be a used car dealership. The property was transferred to the current owners in October 2025; however restrictive covenants were recorded for this property in 1991. In order to connect to city utilities, the new owners must request annexation in accordance with city requirements. The rear adjacent property as well as the property on one side is within the city limits. The city's future land use map identifies the property as HC, and the requested zoning upon annexation, if approved, is also HC. Hucks said that Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the requested zoning upon annexation at their February 5 meeting and following their recommendation a proposed ordinance to zone the property HC will be forwarded for consideration separately from the annexation ordinance. Hucks said that staff recommends approval of first reading of the ordinance to annex the subject property.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (A) annexing the property at 3000 Highway 378. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- F. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (B) to annex approximately 0.43+/- acres of property located at 1322 & 1324 Cottage Lane (PINs 338-10-02-0005 & 338-10-02-0006).** Hucks stated that both properties contain a single-family dwelling, owned by the same individual. Annexation is being requested in order to connect to city utilities in accordance with city requirements and restrictive covenants were recorded in November of 2025. More recently, the city rezoned 2 parcels at the corner of Cottage Lane and Church Street from R1 district to the Highway Commercial district, which was consistent with the city's future land use maps and previous uses of the property. In this case, the reverse is true. Neither of these parcels are within the city, and both are currently zoned Horry County HC and contain a single-family residence, which, unless the county has amended their ordinance to exclude, single-family is permitted within their version of the HC district. The applicant is requesting to be zoned R-1 upon annexation; however, R-1 is not consistent with the city's future land use map, no surrounding properties are zoned R-1, and the parcels do not exceed the 3-acre minimum to not be considered spot zoning. The issue of the zoning is something that Planning Commission will consider at their February 5 meeting, and it is possible that if the R-1 district is recommended a future land use map amendment will be necessary. Hucks said that what is being considered for first reading today is just the annexation portion of the request, which Hucks said staff does recommend approval.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by White to approve first reading of Ordinance #2026-03-16 (B) annexing the property at 1322 & 1324 Cottage Lane. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

CONSIDERATION:

- A. Consideration of the approval of a proposed name, "Elmhurst Place," for a new subdivision located on Rockwood Drive and Medlen Parkway. (PIN 338-00-00-0032).** Hucks stated that this proposed development directly abuts the Elmhurst development located on Medlen Parkway and was once a future phase or extension of that development. However, the property has changed hands, and the new developers now have plans in review for what was Phase 5 of Elmhurst, to be named, Elmhurst Place. City ordinance requires that council review and adopt all proposed subdivision names. Hucks said that staff does recommend approval of the requested name.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by White to approve the name of Elmhurst Place. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- B. Consideration of a Special Event – Porchfest 2026 – February 15, 2026 –** Hillary Howard of Conway Downtown Alive presented a special event, Porchfest to be held on February 15, 2026 from 12 Noon to 6:00 p.m. Porchfest will be held on 22 various porches with 28 bands performing. Conway Downtown Alive is requesting road closures on Laurel Street, Seventh Avenue and Elm Street.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to approve the special event, 2026 Porchfest, as presented. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

C. Consideration of a request to extend the Camp Bonfire Special Event Permit –

Rogers stated that the Bonfire would like to extend their special event permit that was approved for October 1, 2025 through January 1, 2026 from 11 a.m. to 9 p.m. on Wednesday through Sunday. The Bonfire has been using the vacant lot next to them to host Camp Bonfire with propane campfire pits with chairs and a temporary building to serve drinks. Rogers said that the first benchmark of the MOU agreement is September 4, 2026.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Blain to extend the special event permit to September 4, 2026. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

Hardwick asked for an estimated time for groundbreaking of a future building at this site. Rogers said that the MOU in place says that the initial phase which would include construction would be 3 years from contract, which would be September 4, 2028

D. Consideration of approval to replace a Police Department vehicle (Long)

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Goldfinch to approve the replacement vehicle for the Police Department. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

PUBLIC INPUT:

- Lizzy Marlowe – spoke to council in opposition of the buffer ordinance from 2018.

There was no further public input. **Motion:** Blain made a motion, seconded by Goldfinch, to close public input. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

CITY ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT:

Emrick informed Council of the following:

1. Wished all a Happy New Year.
2. Emrick said that despite this year's Christmas season being a short one and having one of the few Thursday nights rained out, it was a very successful holiday season. The city welcomed 272,600 people downtown during the month of December. This is an increase of 14.2% over last year. It is the largest number of people ever to be downtown in December. Emrick said that his favorite piece of Christmas data, though, is, with the help of our fantastic volunteers, staff adopted out nearly 3,600 retired elves of the north pole.
3. Last February, Emrick gave an update on the number of visitors to our downtown. Emrick's quote from then, "This calendar year (2025), for the first time ever, we are likely to hit 2 million visitors to our downtown." When he said this, he said he was being optimistic, but not unrealistic. Emrick said that he is excited to report that in the calendar year 2025, Conway had 2.8 million people visit downtown. An increase of 15.7% over 2024. To put that number into perspective, Hilton Head Island welcomes 2.5 million visitors annually.

4. Emrick said that his prediction for 2026 would be very close to 3 million number this year. To achieve that, however, staff will need some help from Ed Piotrowski and Jamie Arnold. The single biggest impact on our numbers is the weather.
5. At the request of the Wild Wing neighborhood, staff conducted a Speed Study on Woodstork Drive. The posted speed limit in Wild Wing is 25 mph. The average speed in the neighborhood was 29.75 mph. This would not warrant any additional measures to limit speed. However, the posted speed limit signs are not the traditional speed limit signs, rather they are smaller and were installed by the Wild Wing HOA. There is a question about the enforceability of the speed limit in this area given their lack of uniformity with our city speed limit signs. If any action were to be taken there, the installation of appropriate speed limit signs would be that recommendation.
6. Emrick gave a brief update on some of the projects that the city completed during 2025:
 - a. The Parks Master Plan was completed and is already being implemented.
 - b. The Riverwalk Extension was completed and opened last February.
 - c. The city took ownership of 825 acres from Santee Cooper, including the Steam plant site, the former ash ponds and Lake Busbee
 - d. Town Green project was completed, including the construction and opening of the downtown Splash Pad.
 - e. Holiday Alley was completed, making pedestrian safety and connectivity a highlight of our downtown and allowing the holiday celebrations to dictate infrastructure, while at the same time, making further connections between downtown and the riverfront.
 - f. The restroom facilities at Riverfront Park were rebuilt, after finding former flood damage that was too great to make easy repairs, the bathrooms were upgraded to better fit the vernacular of downtown.
 - g. With the help of the South Carolina Department of Commerce, staff completed a Strategic Plan for the City, which will help guide the city in decision making in the upcoming years.
 - h. The city expanded the National Register of Historic Places Downtown District, adding 59 properties to the district.
 - i. The new Crabtree Pump Station came online in 2025. This project was partially grant funded, partially funded by GSWSA and the City and will provide capacity on the city sewer lines which will allow for future growth and provide relief during flooding events that are used to overwhelm the city sewer system in this area.
 - j. The roof on the Ken Senn building was replaced.
 - k. An infield groomer was purchased by the Recreation Department in August and placed into service. This will dramatically improve the quality of our baseball fields.
 - l. The parking lots at the Oasis Pool, the Dog Park and Sports complex were all paved.
 - m. A new humidifier was installed at the indoor pool, beginning the end-of-life replacement work that is needed to maintain the center in high quality.

- n. Resurfaced 7 miles of roadways, with 5 of those miles being City roads. Repaired nearly 4 miles of sidewalks.
 - o. For the first time ever, the city Fire Department is 100% EMT certified. Despite being a new endeavor, the certification of the city's 39 fire fighters was achieved in less than two years. A remarkable achievement that will greatly benefit our city.
7. Emrick highlighted the big projects underway for this year:
- a. Chestnut Bay is 100% engineered, but since the funding for this stormwater project was cancelled, staff are looking for other funding sources to build this flood relief project in the Sherwood neighborhood.
 - b. The Kingston Ferry is nearly completed with engineering, and staff is waiting on permitting from SCDES and Army Corps. Hopefully by this time next year, the city will be almost ready for a ribbon cutting. The ferry itself will be purchased soon using grant funds.
 - c. The McKeithen Outfall project has been cleared and excavation for the stormwater pond is underway. The project should be completed in June.
 - d. Drainage improvements and redesign of Park View Road is underway. Improvements to the ditch at 16th Avenue will be completed by next week and the remainder of the work will begin in February.
 - e. The Pine/Beaty/Kingston Outfall project is well underway with a completion date of June.
 - f. The utility relocation that is required as part of the 701N widening project is still awaiting bids and staff is working with GSWSA to determine if they would like to upsize the water lines during this process.
 - g. The new Sherwood Pump Station is nearly online, once power is installed and final inspection, it should be ready.
 - h. City crews are also finishing up the surveying work on Medlen Parkway to rework the sewer force main. Medlen also has extensive stormwater completed recently and sidewalks are being installed where this work was done.
 - i. Working on the survey, work for a new water line on Highway 905.
 - j. Working with a group to install a new historic marker at Collins Park to commemorate the Norton Twins. This project will hopefully be completed this year.
 - k. The new park for New Road has playground equipment in storage ready for installation once the space is cleared and ready to go. A survey of the property has been ordered, and this park will be phased with some happening in this fiscal year and some in the next.
 - l. The reconstruction of the Press Box at the Sports and Fitness Center is waiting on staff to draw up plans and have structural engineering to begin. Then it can be bid out for construction.
 - m. New pavilions for Collins Park are being fabricated and will hopefully be installed by the end of February.

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- n. A new community Center and Park are in the planning stages for the Whittemore Area, and new fields are coming to the former Whittemore Elementary School site.
 - o. New gas pumps will be installed at the Marina by the end of January.
 - p. The indoor pool at the Sports and Fitness Center is ready for repainting. Bids are due by the middle of this month and will commence shortly thereafter.
 - q. Upgrades to the Senior Center are underway.
 - r. Field improvements are underway at the site by the Dog Park.
 - s. The Crabtree Greenway Extension is 90% completed with engineering and waiting for SCDOT easements to finish engineering and move on to construction.
 - t. ERF #4, which will accommodate Stella's, River City Café, Crooked Oak, Leone's and more, is on schedule, with brick being installed currently and all infrastructure in place - hope for completion in late winter.
 - u. Engineering of Phase one of the Ash ponds project is underway. Survey work is 90% completed along with a preliminary site plan. Wetland/survey work was approved in December.
 - v. Hawthorne Park has completed engineering and awaiting SCDED Land Disturbance Permits. Construction will begin as soon as permits are in hand.
 - w. Rosehaven Drainage improvements are expected to begin in January. Box culverts have been ordered, and the contractor is awaiting delivery.
 - x. Laurel Street downtown has some drainage issues that we hope to be able to address. The engineering on these improvements has been completed, and we are awaiting SCDOT permits. Hope to bid it out by the end of January.
 - y. The city has brought in a consultant to work with our Police and Fire Departments and evaluate operations to make sure we are prepared adequately for the future and make recommendations to that end. This process is underway and hope to have recommendations by late winter.
 - z. Encouraged council to get budget items to him soon.
8. No department head reports and no workshops, but there is a lengthy Executive Session still ahead.

Goldfinch gave a shoutout to the Fire Department for all having EMT certifications. Goldfinch recommended handing over the 350 acres of waterfowl habitat to Ducks Unlimited with certain provisions. Emrick said that he reached out to Ducks Unlimited but had not heard back but will keep the conversation going.

Blain suggested that smaller vehicles are looked at for the fire department. Emrick said that he hopes the consultants will be able to make recommendations for those items.

COUNCIL INPUT:

Helms

- Told everyone Happy New Year.
- Said it was a humbling experience to be reelected - looking forward to a second term and being nominated as the Mayor Pro Tem.

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- Appreciate staff and all their hard work with the holidays.

Butler

- Said that being on council has been a humbling experience, thanked all the citizens and looks forward to working with everyone for the next 4 years as the city continues to grow.

White

- Said that the lady at 1908 Racepath Avenue inquired about getting a street sign at the alley that goes from Racepath to Ninth Avenue and possibly getting it renamed Lawrence Alley. Emrick said that staff would look into it.
- Asked about the requirements for someone wanting to produce a movie in Conway. Emrick said that the applicant may need a special event permit but can coordinate with Wood or himself.

Goldfinch

- Honored to be back for another 4 four years and working with everyone.
- Commended Bojangles and Singletons Grocery.

Jordan

- Congratulated Helms, Butler and Goldfinch on their reelection.
- Congratulations to all for the 2.8 million visitors.

Hardwick

- Congratulated the returning Council members.
- Thanked staff, volunteers and all citizens for making possible the 2.8 million visitors.
- Excited about Porchfest.
- Said that the fireworks on New Years Eve were phenomenal and told everyone Happy New Year.

Blain

- Welcomed colleagues back for another term.
- Proud of Conway and is glad she gets to choose Conway to be her home.
- Hats off to employees and she appreciates all.

WORKSHOP: None

EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Helms to enter into Executive Session for the following: **(A) Consideration of appointments to boards, commissions and committees [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70(A) (1)]; (B) Discussion of potential contractual agreement regarding City lease of property [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]; (C) Discussion of an Economic Development Opportunity named Project Smokestacks [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (5)]; and (D) Discussion of contractual matter with Horry County Community Land Trust [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)].**

Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

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RECONVENE FROM EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Jordan to leave Executive Session. Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

POSSIBLE ACTION ON MATTERS DISCUSSED IN EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve the appointments of the following board members:

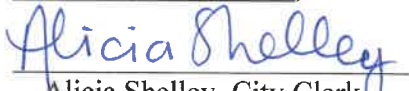
<u>Applicant</u>	<u>Board</u>	<u>Term</u>	<u>Reappointment/New</u>
Kevin Hagen	Board of Zoning Appeals	3 Years	Reappointment
Catherine Dingle	Board of Zoning Appeals	3 Years	Reappointment
Paul Lawson	Board of Zoning Appeals	3 Years	Reappointment
Troy Roehm	CAB	4 Years	Reappointment
Greg Bryson	Planning Commission	3 Years	Reappointment
Tyler Thomas	Water Quality & Drainage	3 Years	Reappointment
Sudie Daves Thomas	Water Quality & Drainage	3 Years	Reappointment
Dylan Jordan	Water Quality & Drainage	3 Years	Reappointment
Travis Leon Todd	Water Quality & Drainage	3 Years	New

Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Butler to select RDE as the Developer for Project Smokestacks. Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

ADJOURNMENT: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Goldfinch, to adjourn the meeting. Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES: Minutes approved by City Council this 20 day of January, 2026.


Alicia Shelley, City Clerk